

Section B Option 1: Crime and deviance

This option focuses on debates in contemporary society through a detailed study of crime and deviance. The social construction of crime and deviance are considered and the ways in which crime is socially distributed, explained and reduced. This option introduces a global dimension, with reference to patterns and trends. It aims to give an understanding of different theoretical approaches to the study of crime and deviance.

Key questions	Content	Learners should:
1. How are crime and deviance defined and measured?	Definitions: • crime and deviance • social order • social control • the relativity of crime and deviance • the social construction of crime and deviance Measuring crime: • official crime statistics • victim surveys • self-report studies	consider the relativity of crime and deviance over time, between societies and within societies. consider the advantages and disadvantages of each way of measuring crime. have awareness that official crime statistics could include police recorded crime figures and the Crime Survey for England and Wales.
2. What are the patterns and trends in crime?	The social distribution of offending and victimisation: • social class • gender • age • ethnicity Patterns of crime in a global context: • global organised crime • green crime	

Key questions	Content	Learners should:
3. How can crime and deviance be explained?	Theoretical views of crime and deviance: • functionalism • Marxism • neo-Marxism/radical criminology • interactionism • realism (left and right) • New Right • subcultural theories • feminism	consider the explanations of crime and the patterns and trends of offending in relation to social class, gender, age and ethnicity.
4. How can crime and deviance be reduced?	Social policy and crime: • left wing: ○ social and community crime prevention and punishment ○ restorative justice ○ structural changes in society • right wing: ○ situational crime prevention ○ environmental crime prevention ○ retributive justice ○ punitive punishment and control	consider policies relating to crime prevention, punishment and control.